

Bauhaus





Marianne Brandt

1919 - 1933





https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Y69wOKg6yp4



ACTIVITY 1 - Starter: Record your thoughts… **SEE, THINK, WONDER**



"What do you notice about the design of this object? What words would you use to describe its aesthetic?"

Record your thoughts… **SEE, THINK, WONDER**

Look at this link:
https://www.metmuseum.org/essays/the-bauhaus-1919-1933

Write **three** to **four short "headline" statements** summarizing the core principles of Bauhaus design based on your findings

Based on observations, what do you think Bauhaus designers were trying to achieve?

Prompt: "Function over Ornament," "Simplified Geometry," "Industrial Materials"

Key Principles on Bauhaus

Bauhaus principles emphasize "form follows function," promoting purposeful, utilitarian design through simplicity, geometric shapes, and minimal ornamentation. Key ideas include the unity of the artist and craftsman, creating a single, cohesive "complete work of art" (Gesamtkunstwerk), using modern materials and technology, and prioritizing usability and mass production.

Key Principles

- **Form Follows Function:** The design of an object should be determined by its intended purpose, avoiding unnecessary decoration.
- **Unification of Arts and Crafts:** The Bauhaus sought to abolish the distinction between fine artists and craftsmen, advocating that the artist is an exalted craftsman who works with hands to create.
- **Gesamtkunstwerk (Complete Work of Art):** The goal was to unite all artistic disciplines—architecture, sculpture, painting, and crafts—into a single, harmonious, unified work.
- **Minimalism:** Designs feature simple, clean lines, geometric shapes, and a limited, logical color palette, often using primary colors.
- **Use of Modern Materials and Technology:** The movement embraced **new materials and industrial processes** to mass-produce functional and affordable designs.
- **Simplicity and Usefulness:** Products are designed to be straightforward, practical, and useful for the end user, making them easier to mass-produce and consume.

Key Principles of Marianne Brandt

Marianne Brandt's core principles included embracing the Bauhaus philosophy of "form follows function," prioritizing rationalism and functionalism in her designs for mass production, using geometric abstraction, and a commitment to creating designs that met practical, utilitarian needs rather than luxury goods. She also valued a harmonious blend of modern industrial design with traditional craftspersonship and explored innovative use of materials and industrial techniques in her work.

Key Principles https://www.youtube.com/shorts/AQGooDQ3BHI

"Form Follows Function": Brandt embodied the Bauhaus motto, designing objects where the shape was dictated by their intended purpose and use.

Rationalism and Functionalism: She designed with simple, elementary shapes and a focus on practicality and efficiency.

Design for Mass Production: Her designs were conceived for industrial manufacturing, considering rationalistic design and the needs of a machine age.

Key Principles of Marianne Brandt... CONTINUED

Utilitarian Focus: Brandt aimed to create objects for real needs and practical demands, moving away from luxury or decorative "joke" articles.

Geometric Abstraction: She abandoned earlier Expressionist styles to embrace clean, geometric forms in her work.

Industrial Aesthetics and Craft: Her designs integrated the elegance and simplicity of industrial design with the meticulousness of traditional craft.

Experimentation with Materials and Techniques: Brandt was willing to experiment with new materials and techniques to create her groundbreaking industrial designs.







ACTIVITY 2 - Brandt's Bauhaus Legacy

How do Brandt's designs specifically exemplify the principles? https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5Qbcc0e3uVY





Create a digital 'analysis table': Using the table below, find at least **two additional images** or **pieces of information** about the object (e.g., production methods, original price, etc.) to support your analysis. Explaining *how* Brandt's design choices align with specific Bauhaus principles.

ACTIVITY 2 - Brandt's Bauhaus Legacy

Product:	Formal Elements	Materials & Methods	Bauhaus Principles Reflected
		The use of metal shows a focus on industrial materials	The spherical form of the teapot demonstrates the principle of simplified geometry
			

Activity 3: The Independent Designer's Judgement

Write an **independent analysis** of a new Marianne Brandt piece the **"Kandem"** table lamp.

Draft a short, paragraph-length analysis that **explains** the **image with reference to specific features** of the design and connect them to at **least two key Bauhaus principles**.



Prompt: "Where does your paragraph explicitly mention 'Bauhaus' or a principle like 'form follows function'?

Activity 3: The Independent Designer's Judgement

Exemplar Response:

It would describe its features (e.g., geometric forms, use of industrial materials like steel), explicitly link these to Bauhaus principles (e.g., **universal design, mass production, 'form follows function'**), and then offer a reasoned judgement on its success (e.g., "**The lamp is a successful design because its simple form and durable materials allowed for widespread use, embodying the Bauhaus goal of bringing art and industry together for everyday life**").

The response would be **concise, well-structured,** and demonstrate a **clear understanding of both Brandt's work and the broader movement**.

